

README File

Paper: Copyright and Creativity: Evidence from Italian Opera in the Napoleonic Age

Authors: Michela Giorcelli and Petra Moser

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This document contains instructions to produce the datasets included in the replication package of Giorcelli and Moser (2020) from the raw data.

Software and Package Requirements

Software Requirements: Stata. The code was written and analysis run on Stata/MP Version 17

Description of the Replication Package

Folder “Raw Data” contains all the data necessary to reproduce the final datasets used to produce GM20 figures and the tables:

- `operas_raw_data.dta` contains operas premiered in Italy between 1781 and 1821
- `theater_raw_data.dta` contains theaters data
- `additional_operas.dta` contains complementary composer-level operas
- `composer_roster.dta` contains composers’ biographical information and overall productivity

Folder “Intermediate Data” contains datasets from GM20 replication package that are used in the response to either perform additional robustness tests or to replicate MT25 analysis:

- `operas_1781_1820`: contains GM20 data at the state-year level between 1781 and 1820.
- `city_level_operas_1781_1820`: contains GM20 data at the city-year level between 1781 and 1820.
- `composer_level_data`: contains GM20 data at the composer-state-year level between 1781 and 1820.

Folder “Code” contains all code necessary to transform the raw data to output data, as well as producing all figures and tables. It is divided in two subfolders:

- GM20_dofiles: contains the dofiles that go from the raw data to state-level results (`GM20_state_level_analysis`), city-level results (`GM20_city_level_analysis`) and composer-level results (`GM20_composer_level_analysis`)

- MT25_dofiles: contains the dofiles used to reproduce the tables included in the Letter to the Editor

Folder “Output” contains all the output files

- GM20_output: contains all the outputs from GM20_dofiles
- MT25_output: contains all the outputs from MT25_dofiles

Construction of Intermediate Datasets

- `operas_1781_1820.dta`: this dataset is used to produce the main results of the paper and the corresponding robustness checks. It is obtained by collapsing `operas_raw_data.dta` at the state-level year. It contains 677 observations. Table 3 (and the corresponding robustness checks) are estimated on the years 1781-1820 to have the same number of years before and after copyright introduction in 1801, which correspond to 657 operas.
- `city_level_operas_1781_1820.dta`: this dataset is used to produce results in Section VII, which estimates the interaction between copyright and pre-existing infrastructure, proxied by number of theaters. It uses `operas_raw_data.dta` when theater information is available, and complements this dataset with detailed historical city-level data on theater, as explained on p. 4203 of GM20. In total, theater information is available for 617 operas.
- `composer_level_data.dta`: this dataset is used to produce results in Section V of the paper, which estimates the effects of copyright on composers' productivity. As explained in the definition of variables in equation (4), it is at composer-level and the outcome variable opera is the number of operas that a given composer creates in a state-year pair. Starting from `operas_raw_data.dta`, this dataset is complemented with information from the *New Grove Dictionary of Music and Musicians* (Grove 2001) and Treccani's (2001) *Enciclopedia Italiana di scienze, lettere ed arti* (GM20 p. 4178). We exclude operas for which the composition state could not be determined,¹ and collapse the dataset at composer-state-year level. We keep the total composition per composer (variable `tot_operas` in the replication package) to compute the share of most prolific composers on the total pool of composers' data (active from 1770 to 1900).

¹ Revivals are reported in the state of composition and year of revival.

Datasets, Do-files and Output used in the Letter to the Editor

Dofile	Output File	Response Table
Replication_Table3_MG20	GM20_Table3	Table 1
GM20_state_level_analysis	tableA10	Table 2
Replication_Table4_MT25	MT25_Table4	Table 3
Replication_Table5_MT25	MT25_Table5	Table 4
Replication_Table6_MT25	MT25_Table6	Table 5
Replication_Table7_MT25	MT25_Table7	Table 6
Replication_PreTrends	Pretrends	Table 7
Replication_TableB1_MT25	MT25_TableB1	Table 8
Replication_TableB1_MT25	MT25_TableB1_Excluding_Modena_Parma	Table 9